

Build Steps

Cowork is task-driven — give Copilot a job, optionally schedule it, let it use your M365.

1 Open Copilot Cowork

Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and switch to Cowork mode (left rail). Confirm the surfaces you have available — Cowork can act on your behalf across:

- Outlook (read, summarise, draft, send, schedule)
- Teams (chats, channels, post messages, read history)
- Calendar (find times, create meetings, prep briefs)
- SharePoint & OneDrive (read files, write Word/Excel/PowerPoint to your files)
- Power BI (semantic models, reports, DAX queries)

2 Paste the Headline Task

Open a new Cowork task and paste the prompt below. This is the worked example for Legal — Contract Review — adapt names, channels, and Power BI reports to your tenant before running.

Every Monday at 8:00am, run the Expiring Contracts Watch:

1. Do NOT send/post automatically — leave the draft for me to review.
2. Open Legal_Contracts_Data.xlsx from /Legal/Contracts/ in SharePoint. Read every row.
3. Filter to contracts where ExpiryDate falls in the next 30 days AND Status is Active or Expiring. Sort by ExpiryDate ascending.
4. For each contract, capture: ContractID, Counterparty, Type, ExpiryDate, AutoRenew (Y/N), Owner, RiskFlag, AnnualValueUSD, GoverningLaw.
5. Group by RiskFlag (High first). Within each group, call out any AutoRenew = N as 'action required' — these will lapse unless renegotiated.
6. Search my mailbox for the last 60 days for messages where the Counterparty name or ContractID appears. Pull the latest thread date and one-line gist as 'recent signal'.
7. Build a Word brief saved to /Legal/Weekly/Expiring_<date>.docx with: executive summary, the table grouped by risk, and an Owner Action List (one line per owner).
8. Draft a Teams message to the 'Legal Operations' channel linking the brief, with counts by risk and the top 3 'High risk + AutoRenew=N' items. Leave as draft.
9. For each Owner with one or more action items, draft a short, neutral email asking them to confirm renewal intent by EOW. Cite ContractID and ExpiryDate. Leave drafts in my Drafts.
10. Never offer legal interpretation — flag, summarise, route to counsel.

3 Set the Schedule

In the task panel, choose Schedule and configure:

- | | |
|-----------------------|---|
| Frequency | Weekly |
| Run Time | Monday 08:00 (lands before Legal Ops standup) |
| Execution Mode | Inline (recommended) — task remembers context across runs |

4 Verify the First Run

Run once now (Run now) before scheduling kicks in. Confirm:

- Every contract expiring in the next 30 days appears — spot-check 3 rows against the workbook
- High-risk + AutoRenew=N items are at the top of the brief
- Owner emails cite ContractID and ExpiryDate, never a generic ask
- No clause-level legal advice in any draft — language stays neutral

Try These Live

Copy any of these into a new Cowork task — one-shot or scheduled.

Risk Clause Sweep

Read every Active MSA in Legal_Contracts_Data.xlsx where RiskFlag is Med or High. For each, summarise the RiskReason in one plain-English sentence and tag the likely playbook category (liability cap / IP / data / termination / indemnity). Build one Word doc grouped by category for the GC's monthly review.

Counterparty Concentration Check

Group active and expiring contracts by Counterparty. List any counterparty with 3+ live contracts and total Annual ValueUSD above \$250k. For each, search my mailbox for their primary contact and pull the most recent thread. Draft a Teams DM to the relationship Owner suggesting a consolidated review. Leave drafts.

Auto-Renew Backstop

List every contract with AutoRenew=Y where ExpiryDate is 60-90 days out. For each, draft a calendar reminder 45 days before expiry titled 'Auto-renew window: <Counterparty>' with the Owner as attendee. Do NOT auto-send invites — leave them as tentative drafts I confirm.

Governing-Law Spread

From the workbook, summarise the distribution of GoverningLaw across Active contracts. Flag any non-standard jurisdictions (anything outside US/UK/EU) and email the GC a short Word note with the list and AnnualValue exposure. Leave email as draft.

How to Think About This Teammate

Cowork replaces:

- Hand-tracking expiry dates in a private spreadsheet
- Forgetting auto-renew windows until the day they fire
- Counsel chasing owners for renewal intent

With:

- ✓ A Monday brief grouped by risk, with action owners
- ✓ Auto-renew backstops on the calendar 45 days early
- ✓ Owner emails drafted with ContractID and date in

Not a chatbot. A scheduled teammate with full access to your M365.

Tip for real-world use

Legal is draft-only. Keep 'do not send automatically' at the top of every scheduled prompt and instruct Cowork to cite ContractID for every claim. Never let it characterise contract language on its own — that's counsel's call. Surface, summarise, route.

You've built a Cowork teammate ✓

You now have a Copilot teammate that can:

- Catch expiring contracts 30 days out
- Spot auto-renew lapses before they bite
- Route risk to counsel, not interpret it
- Keep owners informed with grounded drafts